

A PARISIAN THROWBACK: THE GOOD, THE BAD AND THE NOT-SO-UGLY

The 33rd edition of the Summer Olympics, arguably the **greatest event** on the planet, concluded after a memorable closing ceremony at the Stade de France in Paris on August 11.



Prized 'Marchand'ise: France's Leon Marchand became the most decorated male Olympian at Paris 2024 with four gold and one bronze medals. AP

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The cauldron was extinguished and the Olympic flag was handed over to the next host.

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Exactly 100 years after hosting the Olympiad for the last time, the French capital got the opportunity to greet athletes from all around the world with "Enchanté". This time though, the number of participating nations was 206 (including Individual Neutral Athletes and the Refugee Olympic Team), almost five times more than the 1924 Games.

Therefore, France had the difficult task of maintaining the balance between helping the International Olympic Committee (IOC) in continuing the legacy of the quadrennial event in a responsible manner and also displaying its might as a sporting nation while competing against the rest of the world.